Language Essay Brainstorm

Directions: Use Parts 1 and 2 to brainstorm as many possible essay topics as you can, both personal and cultural. Don't filter yet. In Part 3, choose the topic with the most to say. In Part 4, plan how you will write about it.

Part 1: Personal Connections

Think about the words that have shaped who you are or how others see you. Fill in at least three rows. Only share what you're comfortable sharing.

Category	Prompts to get you thinking	Your example(s)	How has this word shaped you or how others see you?
Your name	What does it mean? Who chose it? Nicknames? Is it mispronounced or shortened?	Mrithyunjay	Boosts confidence in myself as it's the name of one of my favorite gods. The meaning of the name being "Winner of death" gives me more motivation
Labels others give you	"The smart one," "quiet," "the athlete," "dramatic." Do they fit?	Confidently Intelligent	Reinforces my abilities, and helps

			me rethink and value my abilities.
Labels you claim	Words you use to describe yourself: heritage, community, role, interests	Athletic, Dedicated, Smart,	I like to call myself these as most of my hobbies align with athleticism and labeling myself that encourages me to participate in more sports. Dedicated and Smart helps me keep focused and keep working on things with interest as I self appreciate myself while doing

			the activities .
Home and family language	A saying, a word from another language, a phrase only your family uses	Thambi	Builds a strong connection within my family. “Thambi” means younger brother. But I am not a brother to my parents. Regardless they call me Thambi because of how the relationship term has built around the society. There is a stereotype that younger brothers are often outgoing and are easy to get along.

			This term was then normalized to calling people that they feel close to.
A moment words mattered	A compliment, insult, or conversation you still remember	“Long hair looks good on you”, “You look good today”	These compliments help me reflect on myself and increase self love. I feel that self love is the most important thing a person should have and these phrases keep me reminded of it.
Group language	Words from your team, job, fandom, or group chat that outsiders wouldn't get	“One Shoe”	I was labeled this by my tennis coach when I lost my shoe in the

			middle of the rally during a tennis game but I kept playing with just one shoe. This reminds me of the dedication I have towards sports.
Other:			

Part 2: It's 6 7 for Me...

What do you think of the language around you? Give both a positive and a negative opinion for at least three rows.

Topic / focus point	Positive opinions	Negative opinions
Phrases: "Touch grass"	It has a positively intended message with it. It is a suggestion to people that are stuck online, and indoors.	The direct meaning of the phrase doesn't align directly with the message intended.
Phrases: "Crash out"	Connects to the action of the person in a normalized way. It connects to a person opening up instead of having it bottled up. This is something people should definitely do as it helps their mental health	It is often used in a negative connotation while the actions of someone crashing out is necessary at times for their mental health.

Single words: "Chad"		
Single words: "Bussin" or "Rizz"		
Italian Brainrot / brainrot in general	Refers to how wasting your time watching this may affect your productivity, which is an important message for the people.	Direct definition doesn't support the science of the word "brain rot". This shows how the language among people is evolving which may also cause misunderstanding of science among people in the future.
Language overall		
Other:		
Other:		

Part 3: Narrow It Down

Look back at Parts 1 and 2. Circle the two ideas you have the most to say about.

	Idea	Why does this word or phrase matter?
Idea 1	Thambi	Builds a strong connection within my family. "Thambi" means younger brother. But I am not a brother to my parents. Regardless they call me Thambi because of how the relationship term has built around the society. There is a stereotype that younger brothers are often outgoing and are easy to get along with. This term was then normalized to calling people that they feel close to.
Idea 2	Mrithyunjay	Boosts confidence in myself as it's the name of one of my favorite gods. The meaning of the name being "Winner of death" gives me more motivation

My topic: _____Home and family language_____

What does my topic show about language? Check all that apply.

- ☐ It shapes identity
- ☐ It influences thought
- ☐ It reflects culture

My genre: Check one, then explain why it fits your purpose and audience.

- ☐ Personal essay
- ☐ Journalistic essay
- ☐ Blend

Why this genre: __Personal experience would be shared, along with the impact that I had because of the phrase_____
My audience: _Anyone that are very closely connected with their family._____

Part 4: Plan Your Essay

1. Define your purpose: What truth or insight about language will your essay reveal?
How labels that identify a person contradicts the direct definition of the word, but builds a positive impact. However it devolves the language as direct definitions aren't valued as much.

2. Define your strategy: Which rhetorical choices will best achieve your purpose? Consider structure, diction, syntax, tone, anecdote, analogies, and personal observations.
Diction, tone, analogies, structure (showing cause and effect), and personal observations.

3. Identify your model: Which mentor text informs your style or structure? What specific move will you borrow from it?

Personal essays	Journalistic essays
"Cripple"	"Language Evolves Before Our Ears. It's Very 'Satisfying'"
"Simu Liu"	"What is 'It is what it is'"
"On Dumpster Diving"	"The Hidden Grammatical Reason Why 'Weird' Works"
"Remembering 9/11"	"Gender Pronouns Are Changing. It's Exhilarating"
"After Life"	